

Sources Sought Notice

PR 0044040774

Vessel Lease

Department of the Interior
U.S. Geological Survey (USGS)
Pacific Coastal & Marine Science Center
Santa Cruz, CA

The U.S. Geological Survey (USGS), Pacific Coastal & Marine Science Center, is conducting market research to determine the availability of qualified businesses capable of providing vessel services to support deployment and retrieval of scientific equipment offshore of Humboldt Bay, as described below.

This Sources Sought Notice is for information and planning purposes only and does not constitute a solicitation. This is not a Request for Quote (RFQ). The Government is not obligated to issue a solicitation or award a contract as a result of this notice. The Government will not reimburse any costs associated with responding.

The applicable North American Industry Classification System (NAICS) code is **488390**, with a size standard of **\$47.0 million**. The applicable Product Service Code (PSC) is **V124**.

All responsible sources may submit a capability statement demonstrating their ability to meet the requirement. Responses shall be submitted via email to **Joel Berberena** at jberberena@ios.doi.gov and must be received before the close date of this notice. Late responses or responses submitted by other than email will not be considered.

Capability Statement Requirements:

Interested vendors shall provide the following:

1. Vessel name and description, including specifications demonstrating compliance with the requirements.
2. Crew qualifications and captain experience, including experience supporting offshore or scientific operations.
3. Examples of similar work performed.
4. Evidence of U.S. Coast Guard licensing and compliance with safety requirements.
5. Confirmation of ability to meet insurance requirements.
6. Description of any additional relevant capabilities.
7. Company information, including business size, UEI, and SAM registration status.

Requirement Summary:

The USGS requires a vessel to support two offshore scientific missions near Humboldt Bay:

- Deployment of one (1) wave glider, tentatively scheduled for August 13–18, 2026.

- Retrieval of one (1) transponder (approximately 41.6497°N, 125.5047°W, ~3,095 meters depth) and one (1) wave glider, tentatively scheduled for September 21–25, 2026.

USGS personnel will mobilize and load equipment one day prior to departure. The vessel will transit approximately 78 nautical miles offshore to the work site, support deployment and retrieval operations, and return to port.

Minimum Vessel Requirements:

- Minimum 90 feet overall length
- Cruising speed of at least 20 knots
- Equipped with radar, depth sounder, EPIRB, GPS, safety equipment, medical kit, and nautical charts
- Capable of accommodating up to eight (8) USGS and contractor personnel during 24-hour operations
- Contractor shall provide sufficient crew to support continuous 24-hour operations

Minimum Equipment Requirements:

- A-Frame: 15 ft vertical clearance, 10 ft horizontal clearance, 3,500 lbs SWL
- Winch and Wire: 3,500 lbs SWL
- Deck space: Minimum 400 sq ft working deck or equivalent
- Crane: 1,000 lbs SWL

Logistics and Support:

- Mobilization and demobilization in Eureka, CA
- Vessel must support loading and off-loading via shipboard crane or arranged shoreside crane services
- 8 personnel
- Three meals per day, per person, required during operations, with flexibility for 24-hour operations
- Notice of any special dietary restrictions will be provided to the contractor at least ten days prior to mobilization.

Insurance Requirements:

- Bodily Injury: \$100,000 per person / \$500,000 per occurrence
- Property Damage: \$100,000 per incident / \$500,000 aggregate

The Government is seeking information on vendors capable of meeting these requirements. Responses will be used to determine the appropriate acquisition strategy.